do this. He further added that repeated efforts of Ch. Shujaat Hussain, former Prime Minister of Pakistan, Ijaz-ul-Haq, the then Minister for Religious Affairs, and Fazlur Rehman Khalil to resolve the matter amicably were undermined by Musharraf as he needed dead bodies to show to the Americans to protect and prolong his rule (Mir, 2012).

Consequently, suicide bombings escalated in the big cities. As stated by Hamid Mir in the same article, 'Musharraf got the desired dead bodies and we are picking the bodies till today.'

Besides suicide bombing, the terrorists employed all methods, including gun and grenade attacks, IEDs with remote controls and timers, to create terror. Even before TTP came into being in a formal manner in 2007, its components were fully involved in militant and terrorist activities. It was especially after General Musharraf's Operation 'Silence' on Lal Masjid in July 2007 that TTP accelerated its actions in FATA, Swat, KP (formerly NWFP) and the rest of Pakistan. The extremists came down hard on the state and the military operation in the tribal areas of Waziristan and Swat only escalated it (*Pakistan Insider*, 2011).

Only 13 days after its formal formation (14 December 2007), one of the boldest and most heinous terrorist acts attributed to the TTP was the assassination of Benazir Bhutto, former Prime Minister of Pakistan. Baitullah Mehsud had threatened her before her return from self-exile. The modus operandi was suicide attack and firing.

The emboldened militants attacked the army's general headquarters (GHQ) on 10 October 2009. The attack was carefully planned and considered the boldest yet against the military. Ten Taliban fighters shot their way into GHQ to take hold of senior military officers as hostages in order to demand the release of more than 100 high-profile prisoners held by the security forces.

The militants failed to achieve their primary objectives, as army commandos stormed into the building, killing nine and capturing the injured leader of the group. However, the militants gained the psychological edge as they reached inside the HQ of the Pakistan Army (*The Nation*, 2009).

Apart from direct methods of terrorism, TTP at least threatened to use unconventional methods of killing. It threatened the Rawalpindi Cantonment Board and the Chaklala Cantonment Board, through a letter, of contaminating water sources and reservoirs with poisonous material to pressurise the army to stop its military operation in